

By waving these bristles, the copepod pushes water over its tiny gills and also traps phytoplankton.

Countless copepods

Copepods are the most common animals in the sea.

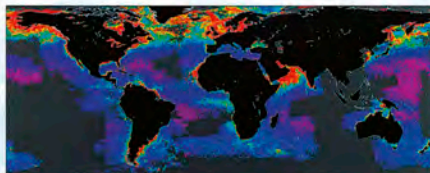
Eye

At night, copepods drift nearer to the surface and hunt for food. During the day, they sink deeper down to hide from hungry birds and fish.

Copepods can't swim against the sea, but they can move around by using their feelers as oars.

Soupy seas!

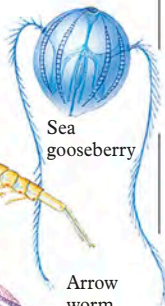
Phytoplankton live near the surface of seas and oceans where there is lots of light. They also prefer cooler water because it has more minerals in it. Zooplankton eat phytoplankton, so they are found in the same places. This map of the world shows where they both live. The red, yellow, and green areas have more plankton than the blue, purple, and pink areas. Plankton have not been counted in the gray parts.



Zooplankton—Animals



Tail



Sea
gooseberry

Krill

Arrow
worm

Phytoplankton

Lots of phytoplankton have joined together to make this chain. The chain is too big to be eaten by many zooplankton.

